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UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT HONOURS 10 INSPIRATIONAL INDIVIDUALS

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan greets Abu Dhabi Award winner Obaid Bin Kanish Al Hamli during the Abu Dhabi Awards ceremony, at Qasr Al Hosn. The President honoured 10 inspirational individuals whose selfless deeds have positively impacted the UAE community.

SEE ALSO P4

Latest innovations at Dubai Airshow

200 aircraft, space tech to feature in event starting today

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, said that the UAE will today host one of the world's largest aviation exhibitions, featuring participation from 115 countries, 490 civilian and military delegations, and nearly 150,000 visitors.

On his X account, Sheikh Mohammed tweeted: "The

150,000

visitors and 490 civilian and military delegations from 115 countries expected

Dubai Airshow will showcase the latest innovations in airport and aviation technology, with more than 200 advanced aircraft on display across both civilian and military sectors."

"The event will also include a dedicated exhibition and conference focused on space technologies," Sheikh Mohammed added.

Dubai Airshow 2025 is set to inspire a new chapter in sustainable aerospace, uniting global industry leaders to drive practical solutions towards a net-zero future.

With sustainability as a core theme, the 19th edition aims to accelerate the adoption of innovative green technologies, decarbonise the aviation ecosystem, and demonstrate how international events can turn climate ambition into concrete action. The event will bring together major players including Dubai Airports, Airbus, Boeing, the World Economic Forum, Airports Council International and the General Civil Aviation Authority.

SEE ALSO P5

UK to cut refugee benefits, extend waiting time

REFUGEES TO WAIT 20 YEARS BEFORE THEY CAN APPLY TO LIVE PERMANENTLY

LONDON

Britain will drastically reduce protections for refugees and end automatic benefits for asylum seekers, the Labour government announced late Saturday, under new plans aimed at slashing irregular immigration and countering the hard-right.

"I'll end UK's golden ticket for asylum seekers," interior minister Shabana Mahmood declared in a statement.

Presently, those given refugee status have it for five years, after which they can apply for indefinite leave to remain and eventually citizenship.

But Mahmood's ministry, known as the Home Office, said it would cut the length of refugee status to 30 months.

Regularly reviewed

That protection will be "regularly reviewed" and refugees will be forced to return to their home countries once they are deemed safe, it added.

The ministry also said that it intended to make those refugees who were granted asylum wait 20 years before applying to be allowed to live in the UK long-term. Currently, they can do so after five years.

Asylum claims in Britain are at a record high, with some 111,000 applications made in the year to June 2025, according to official figures.

The Home Office called

Shabana Mahmood's ministry, known as the Home Office, said it would cut the length of refugee status to 30 months from 5 years.

the new proposals, which Mahmood is due to lay out in parliament today, the "largest overhaul of asylum policy in modern times".

It said the reforms would make it less attractive for irregular migrants to come to Britain, and make it easier to remove those already in the country.

Modelled on Denmark

The measures, modelled on Denmark's strict asylum system, were announced as Prime Minister Keir Starmer comes under pressure from surging popularity for the anti-immigrant Reform UK party.

But the head of Britain's Refugee Council warned the government the measures would not deter people from trying to reach Britain, and urged a rethink.

A statutory legal duty to provide support to asylum seekers, introduced in a 2005 law, would also be revoked, the ministry said.

That means housing and weekly financial allowances would no longer be guaranteed for asylum seekers. — AFP

NATION

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ENTERTAINMENT

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